



COLUMBIA PARK RENEWAL

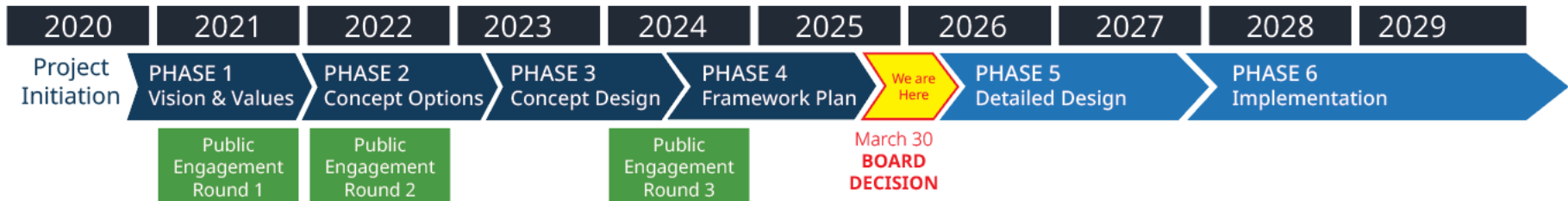
Concept Plan

Park Board Committee Meeting
Monday, March 30, 2026



- To share the results of the public engagement process for the Columbia Park Renewal Project.
- To provide an overview of the proposed concept plan including an underground city stormwater detention tank that will help prevent downstream flooding.
- To seek a Board decision on the proposed concept plan to advance the project to detailed design and park construction, pending available capital funding.

A Blue Green Framework for Alberta Street & Columbia Park

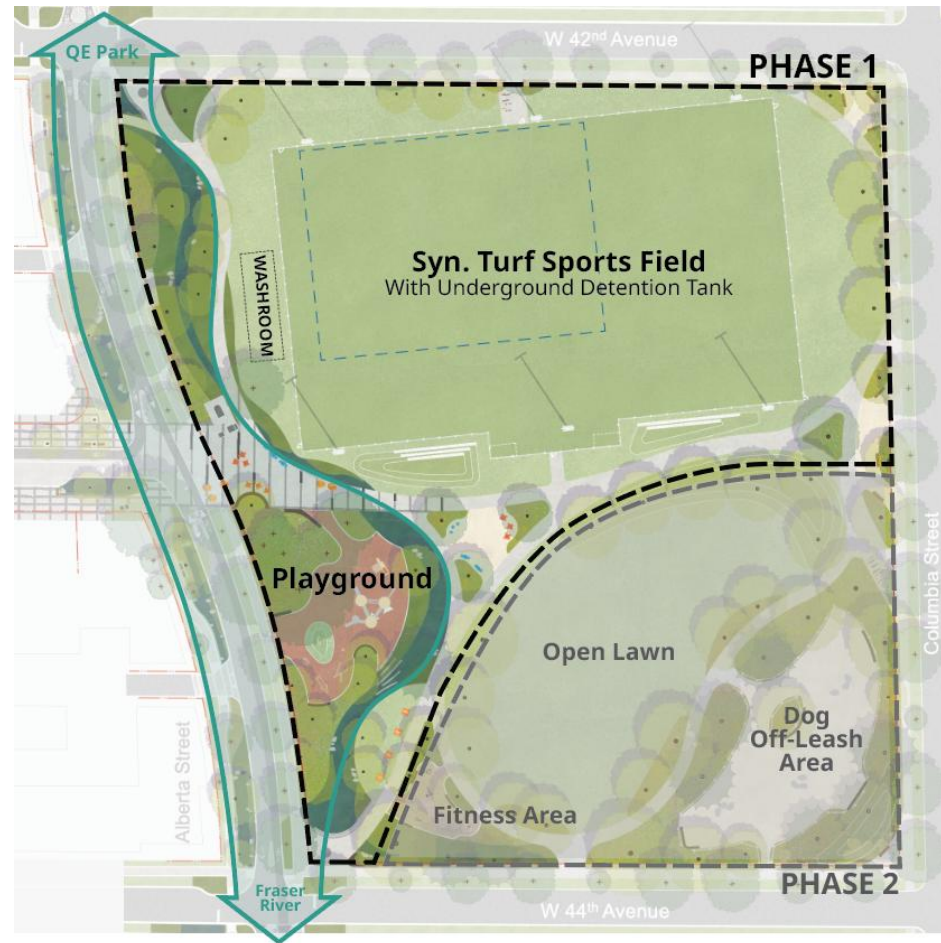


- Located in the Oakridge Local Area
- Initiated as an integral component of the ***Alberta Street Blue Green System and Columbia Park Renewal Project*** that jointly addresses:
 - Population Growth & Densification
 - Storm and Sanitary Sewer Separation & Capacity
 - Climate Resiliency
 - Park Services & Connectivity
- Initiates the 'Little Mountain to Big River' vision as per VanPlay
- Supported by principles outlined in the multiple policy documents (VanPlay, Urban Forest Strategy, Sports Field Strategy, Rain City Strategy, People Parks and Dogs Strategy, etc.)



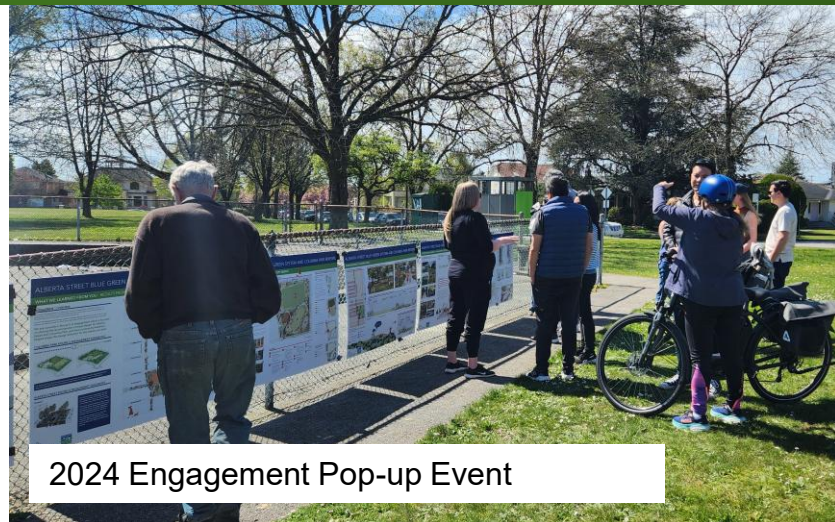
Concept Plan – Key Areas and Features

- **Blue Green Edge** manages rainwater and supports broader habitat corridor
- **Syn. turf sports field** above detention tank – compatible with infrastructure supports year-round recreation in a high-density context
- **Playground** with increased inclusivity
- **Plazas and looped pathways** to support accessibility and social connection
- **Washroom** - replaces Portland Loo
- **Green open space** for informal socializing and recreating
- **Fenced dog off-leash area (OLA)** to provide a clearly demarcated space for people and dogs



Engagement Overview and Summary

- Three rounds of engagement
- Engagement activities included:
 - Shape Your City page and surveys
 - 4 public information sessions
 - April 2024: 4979 postcards, 78 project and stakeholder emails sent, 7 on-site signs posted
 - Interest group meetings with the Vancouver Field Sports Federation



What we heard:

- Strong excitement for a new, larger playground with shade, fenced OLA, and green open space
- Mixed feedback on fenced synthetic turf, with some preference for natural lawn
- **Overall support for the recommended Columbia Park concept**



Total estimated project costs for Columbia Park Concept Phase 1 is \$19M, to be cost shared with Engineering.

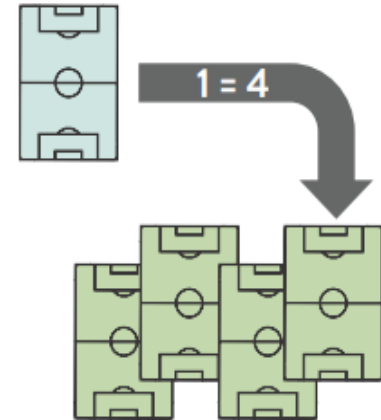
Phase 1 Funding:

- **Engineering Contribution:** Engineering is offering up to a 50% cost share for this first phase of park renewal to compensate for the use of parkland and replacement of existing impacted features, for an underground stormwater storage tank.
- **Park Board Contribution:** Requires a funding allocation of approx. \$9.7M in the 2027 to 2030 Capital Plan to advance detailed design and construction, pending Board decision.
- Estimated annual operating impact to the capital budget is ~\$0.44M, including \$0.06M for synthetic turf operations

Synthetic Turf vs Natural Turf Field Key Considerations

- **Challenge of comparing costs:** Capital cost alone is misleading because while syn. turf has a higher upfront cost, it supports significantly higher use, which directly influences revenue potential and cost recovery.
- **High Density Area:** Effective field closures for rest and recovery of natural turf fields is difficult in high-density areas. Limiting informal use requires a level of enforcement that is not feasible, and fencing is not recommended due to unintended uses (ie dogs)
- **Park Provision:** As synthetic turf fields accommodate more use at a single field, there is an opportunity to free up scarce, valuable space in the park system for other park uses.
- **Sport Field Strategy's Environmental and Human Health Report** includes further information and comparison between natural and synthetic turf fields.

1 SYNTHETIC TURF = 4+ NATURAL TURF FIELDS
IN BOOKABLE HOURS OF PLAY



Synthetic Turf vs Natural Turf Field Analysis

Considerations	Synthetic Turf (Recommended)	Natural Turf (Class A - B)
Service Levels & Utilization	- High, year-round capacity that supports high-intensity ~3,000 permitted hours/year (equivalent to 4 Class A sports fields) - Resilient under high use and wet conditions	- Capacity limited by seasonal conditions, turf recovery - not intended for continuous, high-intensity use ~300–600 permitted hours/year depending on Class - Higher risk of surface deterioration
Cost Considerations	- Higher upfront capital cost (\$\$\$\$) - Recovers more than 100% of expenses through revenue	- Lower upfront capital cost (\$-\$-\$-\$) - Recovers 8-10% of expenses through revenue (Ongoing maintenance costs not fully recoverable)
Operations & Maintenance Inputs	Require low-to-moderate, specialized maintenance (grooming, infill replacement) - Can accommodate continuous use	Require high, consistent maintenance (mowing, watering, fertilizing, aerating) - Need rest periods to manage wear.
Notes on compatibility with underground tank	Recommended by Sports Field Strategy when detention tanks are required - Surface performance less sensitive to subgrade conditions	Less suitable due to turf health sensitivity, drainage reliance, and settlement risk - Subject to more significant future disruptions and extended closures for tank access to recover turf health

NOTE: All-weather fields were not considered, due to technical incompatibility with stormwater infrastructure and limited user acceptance as identified in the Sports Field Strategy

- A. THAT the Vancouver Park Board approve the concept plan for the renewal of Columbia Park as described in this report and shown in appendices;
- B. THAT the Vancouver Park Board approve of the use of a portion of Columbia Park for an underground city stormwater detention tank managed by the City's Engineering Department; and
- C. THAT the Vancouver Park Board authorize the General Manager of Parks and Recreation and the City's Engineering Services General Manager to finalize and execute funding and land use agreements for the use of Columbia Park by the Engineering Department for a stormwater detention tank to the satisfaction of the General Manager of Parks & Recreation.

